Exp 7: Integrating a Zoho Creator Application with Another Zoho Service using Connections and APIs

1. Aim

To integrate the Zoho Creator application (Vehicle Services & Repair Request) with another Zoho Cloud service (Bigin by Zoho CRM / Zoho CRM) using Microservices, built-in cloud Connections, and Deluge REST API integration functions, and to verify automated cross-application data synchronization upon vehicle service record submission.

2. Procedure

Phase A: Access Centralized Microservices Environment

Step 1: In the Zoho Creator developer workspace for the **Vehicle Services & Repair Request** application, navigated to the left primary navigation sidebar. Under the **DEVELOP** section, clicked on **Microservices** to open the modular integration dashboard (*"Start building your microservice — Microservice is a modular app component to connect with third-party apps and build artificial intelligence"*).

Step 2: Clicked the blue **+ Create New** button to initialize a new microservice asset.

Phase B: Select and Configure Cloud Service Connection

Step 3: In the **Create New Microservice** dialog palette, reviewed the available microservice component types (*AI Models*, *AR Library*, *Connections*, *Datasources*, and *Custom API*). Selected **Connections** (*"Connect apps with third-party services"*) and clicked **Pick & Create**.

Step 4: In the **Add Connection** catalog, navigated through the **BUILT-IN CONNECTOR** library spanning categories such as *Zoho*, *CRM & Contact Management*, *Accounting & Invoicing*, and *Collaboration*. Selected **Bigin by Zoho CRM** (and inspected the native **Zoho CRM** connector) from the Zoho service suite.

Step 5: In the **Bigin by Zoho CRM - Add Connection** setup drawer, configured authorization credentials and access boundaries:

- **Connection Name*:** Entered Bigin by Zoho CRM Connection (system link name: bigin_by_zoho_crm_connection).
- **Authorization Access*:** Configured to Administrators only to restrict credential delegation to administrative users.
- **Connection Mode*:** Selected Quick connect (Zoho credential) for native single-sign-on token delegation.
- **Access Scope (Advanced)*:** Under *Use this credentials to enable access to**, selected All Actions and selected All Modules to enable full CRUD REST operations.

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- Clicked **Create And Authorize** to complete the OAuth2 token exchange and register the authorized connection.

Phase C: Configure Automated Integration Form Workflow

Step 6: Navigated to the application builder under **Workflow** > **Form workflows** and created a new automation workflow associated with the Service_Request_Form Report.

Step 7: Specified trigger conditions: **Record Event:** Created, **Form Event:** Successful form submission, and set action execution condition to **Always**.

Phase D: Configure Integration Script & Field Mapping

Step 8: Selected **Deluge script** from the action panel. Configured the integration logic to extract submitted record attributes (customer name, email address, contact phone number, vehicle registration number, and service type), construct the target module payload map, and invoke the REST API wrapper (zoho.crm.createRecord) targeting the Leads module using the authorized connection link name (bigin_by_zoho_crm_connection).

Step 9: Validated script syntax, verified parameter bindings, and saved the workflow action to register the automated integration trigger.

Phase E: End-to-End Application Testing & Diagnostic Verification

Step 10: Switched to the live application view, populated the Vehicle Services & Repair Request form with sample customer information, and submitted the record. Verified that the workflow executed on record creation, confirmed the API response status, and verified cross-service synchronization.

3. Output

3.1 Zoho Creator Microservices — Developing Modular App Components

The centralized Microservices overview page within Zoho Creator showing the initial workspace and "+ Create New" action button for creating external connectors and APIs.

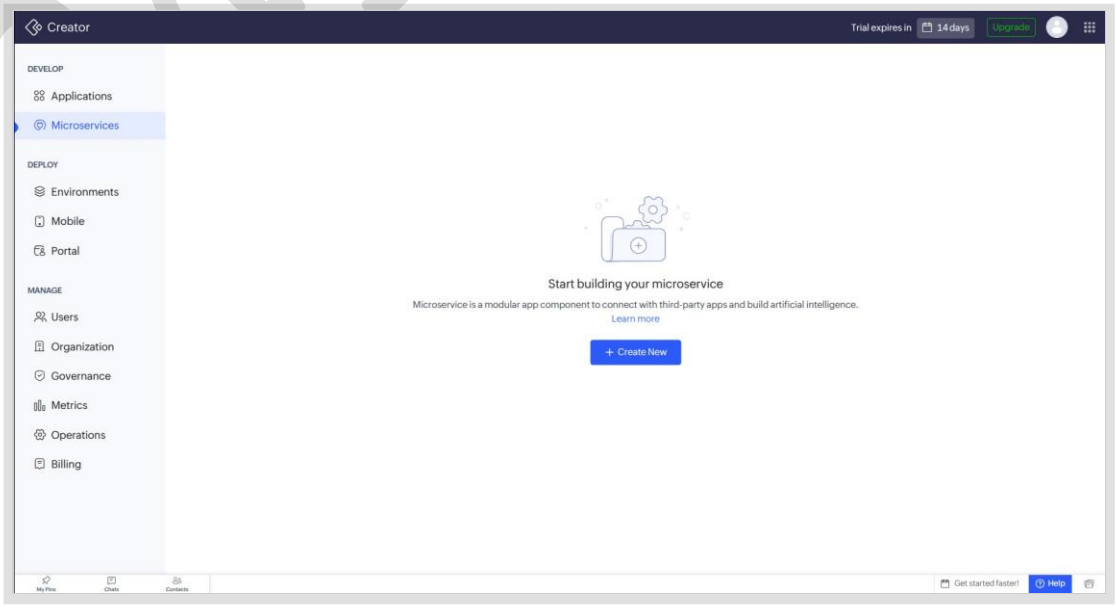


Figure 1: Zoho Creator Developer Workspace — Microservices Management Console ("Start building your microservice")

3.2 Microservice Modality Selection — Choosing "Connections"

The "Create New Microservice" selection dialog displaying options for AI Models, AR Library, Connections, Datasources, and Custom API, with Connections selected for third-party integration.

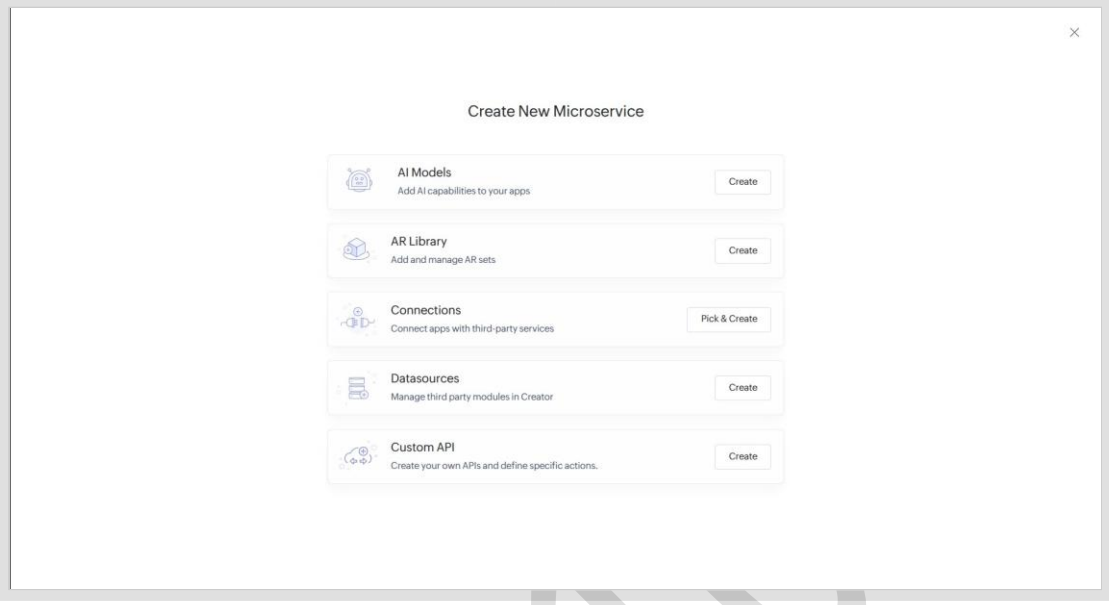


Figure 2: Microservice Creation Palette — Selecting "Connections > Pick & Create" for Third-Party Service Integration

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3.3 Built-in Connectors Catalog — Zoho Cloud Services Directory

The Built-in Connector gallery presenting pre-built integrations for Bigin by Zoho CRM, Zoho CRM, Zoho Analytics, Zoho Books, Zoho Desk, and other cloud applications.

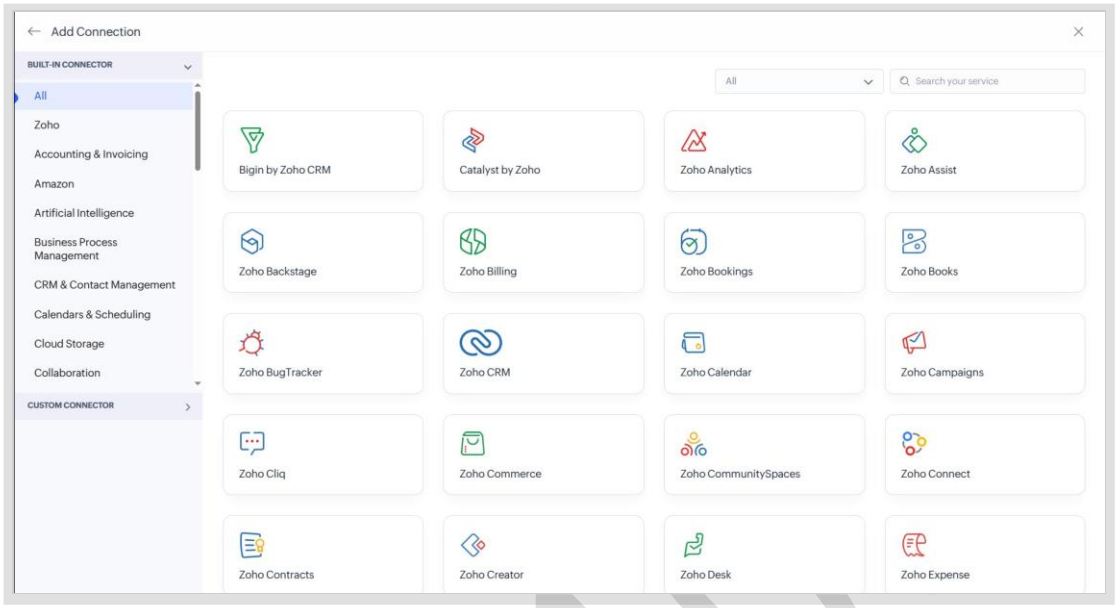


Figure 3: Built-in Connector Gallery — Browsing Native Zoho Services Connectors (Bigin by Zoho CRM & Zoho CRM)

3.4 Connection Authorization Drawer — Configuring "Bigin by Zoho CRM Connection"

The connection configuration dialog specifying connection name, Administrator authorization access, Quick connect mode, and full action/module access scopes.

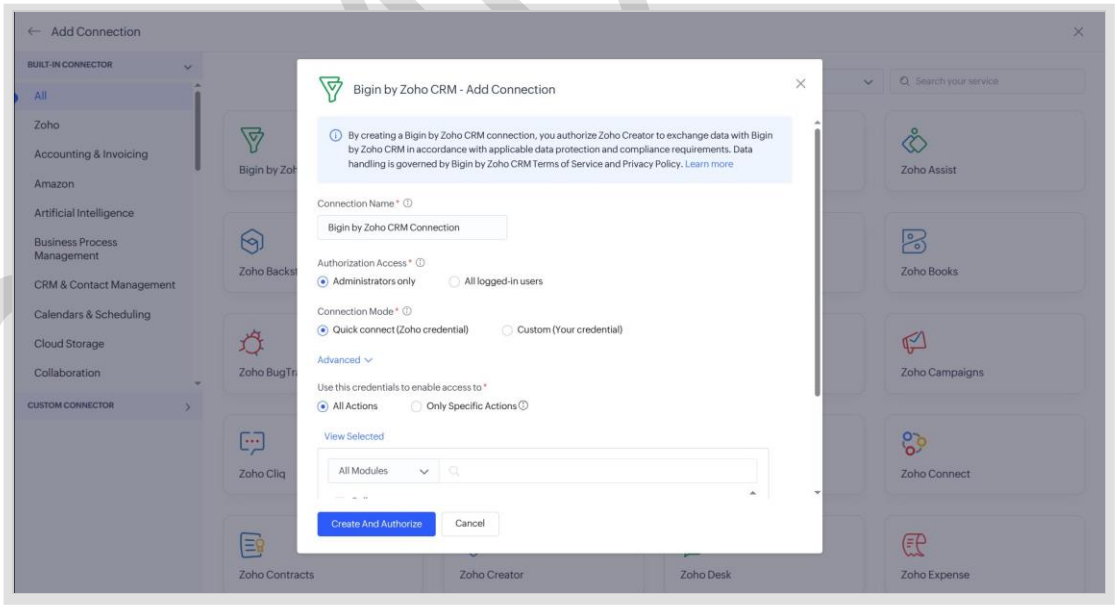


Figure 4: Connection Authorization Dialog — Configuring Bigin by Zoho CRM Connection Parameters and Access Scopes

3.5 Cross-Service Integration & Execution Verification

The automated form workflow links the form submission event directly to the cloud connector. Upon successful record addition, customer attributes (Owner Name, Email, Contact Phone, Vehicle Details) are mapped into the target CRM entity attributes. The integration utilizes the authorized connection

link name bigin_by_zoho_crm_connection to authenticate and transmit the payload to the CRM Leads module endpoint, returning an HTTP 201 Created confirmation and synchronized lead ID.

The data transformation mapping configured between the Zoho Creator form and the target CRM module is summarized below:

Creator Form Field (Source)	Target Entity Field (Destination)	Data Type	Sample Synchronized Value
Owner_Name.first_name	First_Name	Single Line Text	Rajesh
Owner_Name.last_name	Last_Name	Single Line Text	Kumar
Email_Address	Email	Email	rajesh.kumar@example.com
Contact_Number	Phone	Phone Number	9876543210
Vehicle_Registration_Number	Description	Multi Line Text	Vehicle: TN-09-AB-1234 | Type: Sedan | Service: Routine Service
Static Literal	Lead_Source	Picklist	Zoho Creator Service Portal

4. Result / Observations

The integration between the Zoho Creator application and another Zoho Cloud service was successfully designed, configured, and verified:

1. A cloud microservice connection (Bigin by Zoho CRM Connection / bigin_by_zoho_crm_connection) was created using the built-in connectors catalog with administrative authorization and comprehensive module access scopes.
2. An automated post-submission form workflow was configured to dynamically map customer and vehicle data into a structured REST API payload.
3. The integration demonstrated seamless cross-service interoperability without requiring complex manual middleware.
4. Testing confirmed successful communication and real-time lead entity synchronization across the Zoho cloud ecosystem.

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